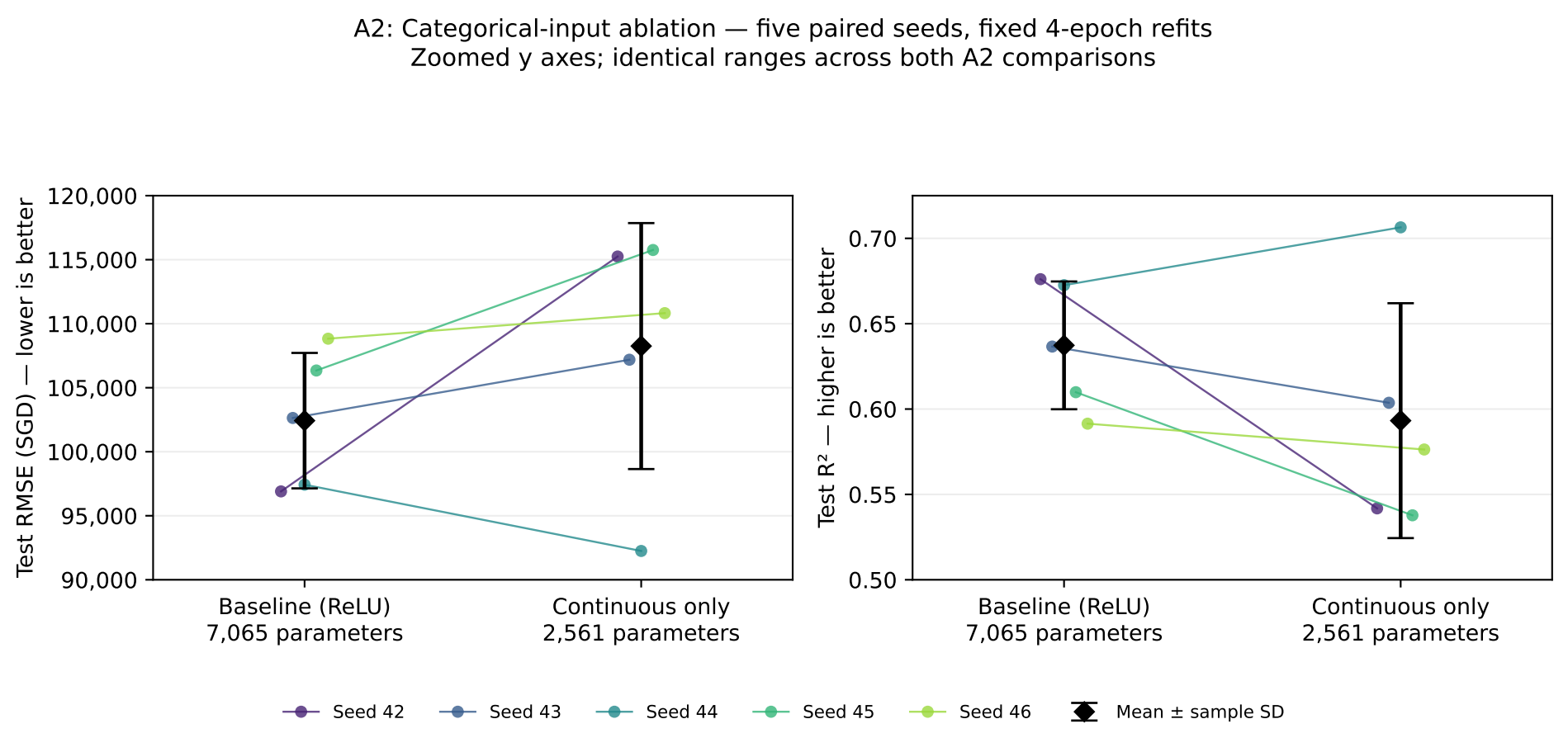
A2: Categorical-input ablation — five paired seeds, fixed 4-epoch refits
Zoomed y axes; identical ranges across both A2 comparisons
Test RMSE (SGD) — lower is better
120,000
115,000
110,000
105,000
100,000
95,000
90,000
Baseline (ReLU)
7,065 parameters
Continuous only
2,561 parameters
Test R² — higher is better
0.70
0.65
0.60
0.55
0.50
Baseline (ReLU)
7,065 parameters
Continuous only
2,561 parameters
Seed 42
Seed 43
Seed 44
Seed 45
Seed 46
Mean ± sample SD